

EXPERIMENT 5

Dashboard Creation in Zoho Creator

1. Aim

To create and implement a dashboard in Zoho Creator to visualize and manage application data using different widgets, charts, and reports, and to learn how to develop an interactive dashboard for a business application.

2. Introduction

A Dashboard in Zoho Creator is a visual interface that displays important application data and key performance indicators in one place. It helps users view essential information quickly through widgets, charts, graphs, and quick links. Dashboards support better decision-making by presenting data in a clear, organized, and attractive format. Zoho Creator offers drag-and-drop dashboard components that can be connected to different forms and reports. Users can customize dashboards by adding charts, summary widgets, and navigation links to obtain a complete overview of their business activities.

3. Objectives of the Study

- To learn the meaning and importance of dashboards in Zoho Creator.
- To understand the steps involved in creating and setting up a dashboard using various widgets.
- To study the process of adding charts, summary cards, and quick links to a dashboard.
- To understand how to modify the dashboard layout and customize its components.
- To create a working dashboard based on a real-world business application.

4. Procedure

- Sign in to the Zoho Creator platform.
- Open an existing application or develop a new application based on the selected use case.
- Go to the Dashboard section and create a new dashboard.
- Insert summary widgets to show important values such as total amounts, total orders, and total unit prices.
- Select suitable data sources and aggregation methods for each widget.
- Add chart widgets, including bar charts, pie charts, and line charts, to represent data visually.
- Set the required X-axis and Y-axis fields for the charts.
- Include quick links to forms to simplify data entry and movement between application sections.
- Organize and adjust the dashboard components to achieve a clear and attractive layout.

- Save the dashboard and preview it to check its design and working.
- Make necessary changes to the dashboard components, if required.
- Publish the application after finishing the dashboard implementation.

5. Illustrative Example

Consider a Food Delivery System developed using Zoho Creator, where information about orders, customers, menu items, and restaurant branches is maintained in an application.

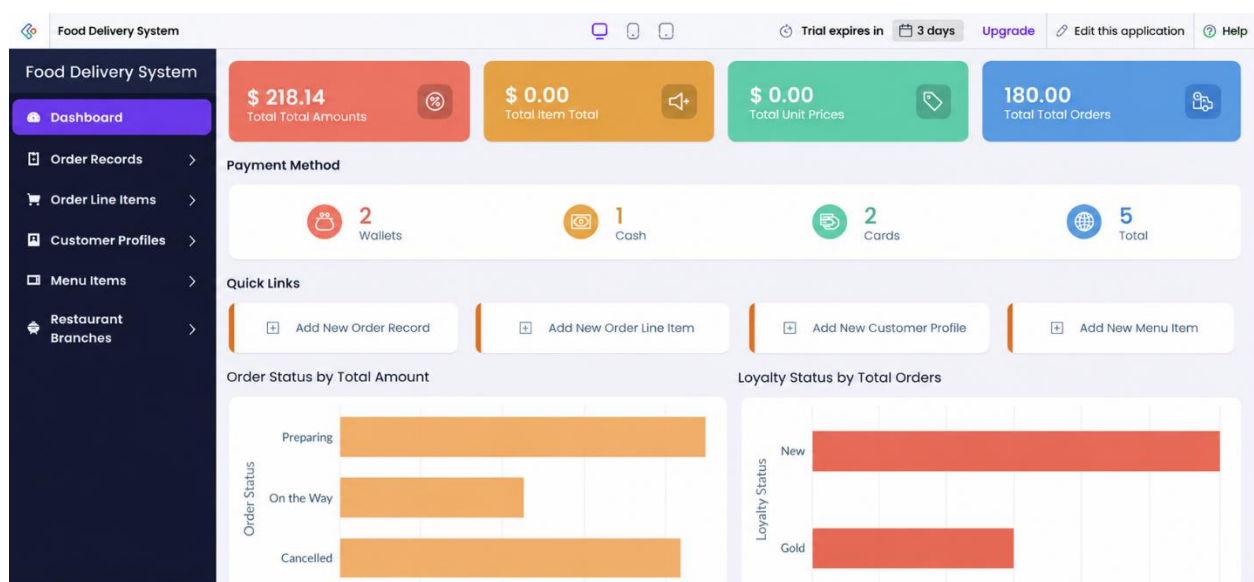
5.1 Implementation using Zoho Creator

A dashboard is developed for the Food Delivery System to provide an overview of business activities. Summary widgets are added to display Total Amounts, Total Item Total, Total Unit Prices, and Total Orders.

A Payment Method section is included to show the number of Wallet, Cash, and Card payments, along with the overall Total. Quick Links are provided for adding new Order Records, Order Line Items, Customer Profiles, and Menu Items.

Bar chart widgets are created to represent Order Status by Total Amount and Loyalty Status by Total Orders. The dashboard is connected to the application data so that information can be viewed and updated in real time. Reports are also generated to access and manage order and customer details efficiently.

5.2 Illustrative Form Design



6. Advantages and Limitations

6.1 Advantages

- Displays important business information in a single location.
- Makes data easier to understand through charts and visual elements.
- Supports business monitoring through real-time data updates.
- Provides quick links for convenient navigation and record creation.
- Allows users to adjust dashboard components through a drag-and-drop interface.
- Minimizes the requirement for preparing reports manually.

6.2 Limitations

- Advanced dashboard modifications may require the use of Deluge scripting.
- Dashboard performance can decrease when handling a large volume of data.
- Creating advanced charts may involve additional settings and configuration.
- The available dashboard features depend on the capabilities of the Zoho Creator platform.
- Large-scale or highly customized enterprise applications may require extra development work.

7. Result

The experiment was successfully completed by learning the process of creating dashboards in Zoho Creator and developing an interactive dashboard for a Food Delivery System. The implementation showed how summary widgets, charts, quick links, and navigation elements can be integrated to present business information in one place with minimal coding.